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Thyra Uth Thomsen, Head of Department, and the assessment committee
Department of Marketing
Copenhagen Business School
Solbjerg Plads 3
2000 Frederiksberg, Denmark

Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing

Dear Thyra Uth Thomsen and members of the assessment committee,

I am applying for this position as an Assistant Professor at WU Vienna. I was trained in marketing: a PhD in Management, summa cum laude, with Manfred Schwaiger at the Institute for Market-Based Management of LMU Munich, with a thesis on simulating human decision-making with large language models, after degrees in mathematics from Vienna and Zurich.

The department studies how people, organisations and technology shape markets. My research asks what happens to marketing evidence once AI makes it cheap to produce. A language model can now answer a questionnaire, and a pre-test that once needed a panel costs almost nothing. Two questions follow for marketing: what can be measured now, and how the institutions that certify evidence must be rebuilt.

My solo paper *When and How to Integrate AI Simulations into Behavioral Experimentation* (Revise & Resubmit at International Journal of Research in Marketing) tests how far simulated respondents can stand in for human participants in behavioural experiments, and where that substitution stops. I simulate 70 treatment effects from 30 published marketing studies at the level of the instrument: each synthetic respondent completes the original questionnaire in one randomized condition. Simulated and human effects correlate at $r = .73$, but the simulations come out at about two-fifths of the human magnitudes. They can rank ideas before a test is run; they cannot yet price them. At CBS this work would meet Felix Eggers' studies of language-model valuations and design priors for choice experiments. His human choice panels and my benchmark could together estimate how much correction synthetic data needs before it can inform a decision.

The second line I would bring to the Digital Marketing Research Cluster is econometric. In a many-analyst study forthcoming in the *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, I was one of 156 analyst teams that estimated brand price elasticities from the same household panel data. Across 10,415 estimates the team averages range from -7.3 to $+3.1$, and choices on time aggregation, fixed effects, time controls and marketing-mix covariates explain the largest share of that spread. Pricing and promotion planning rest on these elasticities, which ties the work to the cluster's projects on online promotions and customer value.

Cheap evidence also changes the institutions that certify it, and my pipeline follows that question from journals to platforms. *After the Fax Machine Burns* (Submitted to Management Science as a Discussion Paper) asks what a journal should do when manuscripts cost almost nothing to write; I derive when each party a publication system serves prefers a public graded record to the accept verdict. Since August I have been negotiating a multi-year data partnership with kununu, the largest employer-review and salary platform in the German-speaking labour market. kununu shows a salary band only once enough employees have reported one, and the paper I am preparing estimates what that threshold does to applicant flows. Antonia Erz has shown that two-sided review systems change how customers behave toward suppliers; an employer-review platform is a two-sided market of the same kind. *Threshold Migration to the Patient* (Accepted at ANZAM 2026) follows a consumer device into a profession's gate: a wearable's algorithm now initiates triage while

the clinician keeps disposition. Constant Pieters' work on replication and measurement validity sets the test that simulated respondents still have to pass, and I would like to build that audit with him.

Teaching is where I can contribute from the first semester. At WU I designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, in which students build and evaluate working agents; 95 % of the students recommend it. This term I run the *Business Project* of WU's master's programme with Vienna Airport as corporate partner, with five student teams and a final presentation to its executives in January. At LMU Munich I taught the *Seminar on AI in Marketing* from 2024 to 2025, and marketing courses at LMU and EM Lyon. At CBS I would offer a full master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method, in which students test simulated respondents against human data and build agentic analysis workflows. It would sit one level above the applied AI courses in the bachelor's programmes and the GMA summer school, and next to Brand Analytics in the EMF. In the longer run I would like to contribute to the new MSc in Artificial Intelligence for Business and to the Cand.merc. in Advanced Strategic Marketing.

I have worked with firms throughout. At LMU I raised over €100,000 in research funding for the institute from national and international industry partners, and as a freelance consultant I ran market research and analytics for clients including Bayer and Allianz. In Denmark my first application would go to the Independent Research Fund Denmark's thematic call Research on Artificial Intelligence, which funds projects of up to DKK 5 million with a named co-PI and at least one PhD student or postdoc; I would apply with a senior colleague from the department. DFF Research Project 1 and Sapere Aude become open to me once my PhD is three years old, and Sapere Aude is the step toward an ERC Starting Grant. For applied projects with Danish firms, Industriens Fond accepts consortium applications on a rolling basis.

I can start on 1 September 2027. From January to March 2027 I am a Visiting Scholar at the Scandinavian Consortium for Organizational Research at Stanford; that stay is already arranged and ends well before the start. The application documents and a statement of how my work fits the department are at `https://sherytash.github.io/for/cbs/`.

Sincerely,

Stefan Herytash